

M-03 — What AI Can and Cannot Do

What is this about?

The tasks where these tools genuinely save you an hour — and how to spot one on your own desk.

The idea, in plain terms

Deepa prepares the MIS pack for a Chennai office. Every Monday she pastes the same 40 rows into a document, rewrites the headings, and turns the numbers into sentences for the management summary. The analysis takes twenty minutes. The formatting takes three hours. The shape work is exactly what these tools do best. In AI Limitations: Rajesh handles purchase for an Ahmedabad unit. He asks an AI tool for the current price of a steel grade. It answers with a figure per tonne. He builds a quotation around it. The real rate is 19 per cent higher.

Key things to know

- **TURN INTO** — facts into sentences, notes into a report
- **SHORTEN** — twelve pages into the six lines that matter
- **RESHAPE** — a paragraph into a table, formal into plain
- **GENERATE OPTIONS** — ten subject lines, five ways to say no

A simple example

Situation: The MIS pack is due at noon. You have the figures in a spreadsheet and a blank management summary to write. Your manager wants to know why rejections rose.

What to do: Ask it to state the three biggest movements, with no causes added.

Remember

- **Four shapes it does well** — Turn into, shorten, reshape, generate options. All language, no knowledge.
- **The ten-second test** — Do I already know everything the answer needs? If no, it is a poor fit.
- **Reframe a poor fit** — Move the knowing to your side. Ask it to write, never to know.
- **The line that stops invention** — "Do not add anything I have not given you." Put it in every prompt.
- **Save the weekly job** — The task you repeat is the one worth turning into a stored prompt.

Inducto Learning & Knowledge — quick reference for M-03. Watch the lesson video for the full explanation; this page is a takeaway, not a replacement for it.